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Question

The following text is from George Marion McClellan's 1895 poem "Eternity."

My spirit swoons, and all my senses cry

For Ocean's breast and covering of the sky.

Rock me to sleep, ye waves, and outward bound,

Just let me drift far out from toil and care,

Where lapping of the waves shall be the sound,

Which mingled with the winds that gently bear

Me on between a peaceful sea and sky,

To make my soothing slumberous lullaby.

Which choice best states the main purpose of the text?

Answer

- A. To illustrate the increasing intensity of the speaker's desire to escape ongoing hardship by gliding on the ocean
- B. To contrast the demands of the speaker's everyday life with the serenity of being rocked to sleep by the ocean
- C. To convey the speaker's longing for the ocean to impart a sense of inner tranquility
- D. To justify the speaker's qualms about being transported by the ocean to a quiet destination